Mukhiya (Head Chef) & Kitchen Supporting Staff

Roles & Responsibilities | Sydney Production Kitchen | Version 1.0

1. Role Overview

The Mukhiya (Head Chef) will be responsible for leading all food production operations at the Sydney BAPS Shayona Production Kitchen. This encompasses three interconnected streams of seva: fulfilling Shayona catering requirements for Sydney Mandir events, producing sweets, farsan, and bakery items (optional) for local Shayona retail, and coordinating large-scale production for distribution to BAPS centres across Australia.

The Supporting Kitchen Staff will assist the Mukhiya across all production activities, ensuring timely, safe, and high-quality output in line with BAPS sattvic standards.

Item	Detail
Role Title	Mukhiya — Head Chef & Production Lead
Supporting Role	Supporting Chef / Kitchen Staff
Location	Sydney Mandir Kitchen, Rosehill
Reports To	Local Production Lead
Primary Mandate	Produce and distribute high-quality sattvic food products for Shayona catering, retail, and inter-centre distribution across Australia

2. Responsibility Areas at a Glance

The Mukhiya's responsibilities span four interconnected areas as defined and prioritised below, all conducted under the principles of seva, sattvic discipline, and operational excellence.

Priority	Responsibility Area	Summary
1	**Shayona Catering & Daily Tiffin Service**	Prepare and fulfil all Shayona catering orders for Sydney Mandir events and prepare and fulfil Daily Tiffin Service orders.
2	**Local Limited Sweets Production**	Produce Gujarati and Bengali sweets for local Shayona retail and inter-centre distribution
3	**Local Limited Farsan Production**	Produce common farsan items (Sev, Gathiya etc.) for local retail and inter-centre distribution
4	**Bakery Production (optional)**	Produce bakery items for local Shayona retail and distribution to Australian centres

3. Skills Required

Mukhiyas and the supporting kitchen staff to have the skills to prepare the following items per the priority. All products must be 100% sattvic — free from onion, garlic, and non-vegetarian ingredients.

Priority	Category	Products (indicative/non-exhaustive/example list)
Catering & Daily Tiffin Services	**Gujarati Items**	Rotli, Thepla, Dal, Shaak, Rice, Khichdi, Kadhi, and seasonal items
	North Indian Items	Roti, Dal Makhani, Sabji, Rice, and approved North Indian menu items
	Farsan & Sweets	As per approved catering menu — event-specific selections
	Salads & Condiments	Kachumber salad, chutneys, pickles, raita, and papad as per menu
Sweets	**Gujarati Sweets**	Kaju Katli, Kesar Katli, Mohanthal, Kaju Roll, Barfi (various), Ladoo (various)
	Bengali Sweets	Rasmalai, Sandesh, and other approved Bengali varieties
Farsan	**Common Farsan**	Sev (various grades), Gathiya, and other approved common farsan items
Bakery (Optional)	**Bakery Items**	Approved bakery range — items to be confirmed by National Lead. Distributed fortnightly/monthly to all Australian centres.

It is preferred that the Mukhiya is skilled in preparing all of the above; however, strong capability in Catering and Tiffin Services is mandatory.

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4. Detailed Roles & Responsibilities

4.1 Shayona Catering

The Mukhiya will be responsible for preparing and fulfilling all Shayona catering orders for events held at the Sydney Mandir, daily tiffin orders, any major Satsang events and Shayona cafe assistance.

Menu Preparation

- Prepare Gujarati and North Indian food items, farsan, sweets, salads, and condiments as per the confirmed menu
- Ensure all dishes meet national Shayona quality, taste, and presentation standards
- Prepare quantities based on confirmed head count plus an approved buffer
- No substitutions to the confirmed menu without approval from the Shayona Local Lead

Event Coordination

- Liaise with the Local Hall Hire & Catering Lead on event requirements, serving arrangements, and timing
- Ensure all food is prepared and ready for serving by the confirmed setup time

4.2 Local Production — Sweets & Farsan (Limited Knowledge)

The Sydney kitchen produces a defined range of sweets and farsan for local Shayona retail and for fortnightly/monthly distribution to BAPS centres across Australia.

Sweets Production

- Produce the approved range of Gujarati sweets such as: Kaju Katli, Kesar Katli, Mohanthal, Kaju Roll, Barfi, Ladoo, and other approved varieties
- Produce approved Bengali sweets as per the national range
- Maintain consistent recipes, ingredient proportions, and presentation standards for every batch
- All sweets produced must meet food safety storage and shelf-life requirements before packaging and distribution
- New sweet varieties require approval from the Local Production Lead before production begins

Farsan Production

- Produce common farsan items including Sev (various grades), Gathiya, Chivdo and other products as per the approved range
- Maintain consistency in texture, taste, oil content, and portion weight across all batches
- Record batch sizes, production dates, and any quality issues in the kitchen production log
- New farsan items require approval from the Local Production Lead before production begins

Quality & Consistency

- All products must pass the Mukhiya's quality check before packaging such taste, texture, and appearance
- Any batch that does not meet standard must be reported to the Local Production Lead before distribution
- Maintain consistent use of approved ingredients and suppliers only

4.3 Bakery Production (Optional)

The Sydney kitchen produces an approved range of bakery items for local Shayona retail and for fortnightly/monthly distribution to all Australian BAPS centres.

- Produce the nationally approved bakery range on a fortnightly/monthly production schedule
- Maintain consistent quality, taste, and packaging presentation across all bakery items
- Ensure all bakery items comply with food safety shelf-life requirements before packaging and dispatch
- New bakery items require National Lead approval and a trial batch review before being added to the production schedule
- Coordinate bakery production scheduling with the distribution calendar to ensure items arrive at centres within shelf-life.

5. Supporting Kitchen Staff — Roles & Responsibilities

The Supporting Kitchen Staff will assist the Mukhiya across all production activities. They operate under the direction of the Mukhiya and Local Production Lead and are responsible for the following:

Production Assistance

- Assist the Mukhiya in all food preparation, cooking, and finishing tasks as directed
- Operate kitchen equipment safely and in accordance with operating manuals and training
- Maintain consistent preparation standards — do not deviate from recipes or quantities without Mukhiya and Local Production Lead approval
- Assist with large-scale batch production of sweets, farsan, and bakery items on production days

Packaging & Cleaning – Kitchen, dining area, cool rooms etc.

- Assist with packaging of all production items under Local Production Lead supervision
- Always maintain a clean and hygienic workstation during and after each production session
- Complete the post-session cleaning checklist and ensure the kitchen is left in a clean, organised state
- Report any equipment faults, cleaning concerns, or hygiene issues to the Mukhiya immediately

Storage and Logistics

- Mange the ‘Kothar’ or Store - Assist with appropriate storage of locally produced goods/items
- Packaging of tiffin orders etc. and assist with dispatch and distribution of locally produced goods to other centers.
- Fulfill the ordering and dispatching of the orders received from other centers by working in co-ordination with the Central warehouse team.

Catering Seva

- Assist with catering event preparation, serving, and pack-down as rostered by the Local Production Lead
- Attend the pre-event briefing and follow the Mukhiya's direction throughout the event
- Maintain respectful, warm service conduct with all haribhakto and guests during events

Continuous Learning

- Be open to learning new recipes, production techniques, and food safety practices
- Participate in training and vimarsh sessions organised by the Mukhiya and National Kitchen Lead
- Take on additional responsibilities as directed by the Mukhiya over time

6. Food Safety & Compliance

All Mukhiya and Supporting Kitchen Staff must adhere to the following food safety standards at all times. These are non-negotiable requirements. BAPS Shayona AU will assist in ensuring appropriate food safety and compliance certifications are obtained as per the state and territory regulations.

Production Records

- Maintain a kitchen production log for every production session: date, products, quantities, batch details, and any quality issues
- Maintain a temperature log for refrigerators and freezers, recorded daily
- Maintain a cleaning log, signed off after every session
- All records must be available for inspection by the National Local Production Lead or food safety authority

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7. Administration & Reporting

Ordering & Stock

- Submit ingredient and packaging orders to the Local Production Lead as per the approved ordering calendar
- Maintain a minimum safety stock of key ingredients to avoid production disruptions
- Conduct a monthly stock count and submit results to the Local Production Lead

Vimarsh & Reporting

- Participate in the monthly Vimarsh as required and share production updates, challenges, and upcoming requirements.